GRC 10ALYTICS JUNE 2026 COHORT

ASSIGNMENT

NOVAPAY

INTERNAL AUDIT & POLICY FRAMEWORK BUILD

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1. **Policy Hierarchy**

   There are two levels in Solstice's policy framework. Foundational rules set the fundamental security and governance standards that are applicable throughout the company while advanced policies offer more precise controls for higher-risk or specialized operations.

   Tier 1: Foundational Policies

   a. Information Security Policy: It defines the general course and standards for safeguarding Solstice's technology and information assets.
   b. Access Control Policy: It specifies how authorized users are allowed, controlled, reviewed and restricted access to systems and information.
   c. Acceptable Use Policy: This establishes guidelines for the proper and responsible use of Solstice's technological resources and information systems.
   d. Incident Response Policy: It offers organizational guidance for finding, documenting, handling and responding to security incidents.

   Tier 2: Advanced Policies

   e. Change Management Policy: It offers a regulated method for requesting, evaluating, authorizing, putting into practice and reviewing changes made to technology and systems.
   f. Third party Risk Management Policy: This policy sets standards for locating, evaluating, and controlling security and compliance risks related to third party service providers.

   Policy Framework Rationale

   The foundational policies offer the fundamental organisational security framework required prior to the implementation of more specialised procedures. Because they call for more specialised risk assessment, approval, monitoring, and coordination across business and technology functions, change management and third-party risk management are positioned in the advanced tier.

2. **Selected Policy for Life-Cycle Application**

   To illustrate the policy life cycle, the Change Management Policy was chosen. The operating cycle follows this order: Request, Assess, Approve, Implement and Review.

CHANGE MANAGEMENT POLICY

Solstice Information Security & Technology Governance

Document Information

Owner of Policy: IT Governance and Information Security

Approval Authority: Chief Information Officer (CIO)
Review Period: At least once a year
Status of Policy: Proposed

1. **Purpose**
   This policy's goal is to guarantee that changes to Solstice's infrastructure, applications, information systems and security measures are handled consistently and under control. The policy aims to minimize service interruption, security issues, errors and unauthorised changes while allowing the secure introduction of essential business and technological advancements.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to employees, contractors, and other authorised personnel who request, evaluate, approve, implement or review modifications to Solstice's technology environment and information systems. It covers planned, standard and emergency modifications that could have an impact on information, applications, infrastructure, security, system availability or business operations.

3. **Key Policy Statements**
   Statement 1- Request
   Any modifications to Solstice's information systems, applications, infrastructure, or security measures must be officially requested and recorded prior to being executed. A change request should specify the rationale for the change, the systems or services involved, the anticipated impact and any relevant risks.

   Statement 2 - Assess and Approve
   All suggested changes need to be evaluated for their potential business, security, operational and service impacts before they are carried out. Changes must obtain approval from the appropriate authorized personnel. Changes that are deemed higher-risk or significant require a suitable level of management approval prior to implementation.

   Statement 3- Implement and Review
   Changes that have been approved must be carried out in accordance with the documented change plan and if necessary tested prior to deployment. Following implementation, the modification needs to be examined to make sure it produced the desired results and didn't cause any unforeseen operational, security or service problems.

4. **Approval and Review**
   This policy must be approved by the Chief Information Officer (CIO), with input from Information Security and pertinent business owners. The policy will be reviewed at least once a year, while it might be revised sooner if Solstice's operations, technical environment, legal requirements, or risk profile significantly change.

5. **Policy Life Cycle**
   Request- Assess- Approve- Implement- Review
   This cycle will ensure that modifications are recorded prior to implementation, assessed for risk, authorized by the relevant authority, carried out under strict control and reviewed after the implementation.